

D435

HR Technology and People Analytics

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

Items

1.

An HR analytics team at a 4,000-employee logistics firm that recently moved to a cloud HRIS built a model using tenure, commute distance, and engagement scores to estimate which warehouse employees are likely to quit in the next six months. The project was sponsored by the COO. Which type of analytics is this?

- A. Descriptive analytics.
- B. Prescriptive analytics.
- C. Diagnostic analytics.
- D. Predictive analytics.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which question calls for prescriptive analytics?

- A. Which retention offer should we make to each at-risk nurse to keep turnover cost lowest?
- B. Which nurses are likely to leave next year?
- C. How many nurses left last quarter?
- D. Why did turnover rise in the ICU last quarter?

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Survey data at a regional bank with 22 branches show that branches with more training hours also have higher customer satisfaction scores ($r = 0.62$). The survey vendor has won industry awards. A VP proposes doubling training hours at every branch to raise satisfaction. What is the best response?

- A. Approve it, because an award-winning vendor collected the data.
- B. Approve it, because $r = 0.62$ proves training drives satisfaction.
- C. Conclude that high satisfaction is what causes branches to train more.
- D. Test it first, such as a controlled pilot at some branches, because the correlation may reflect other factors like manager quality.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An analyst wants to show that a new mentoring program causes lower first-year turnover. Which design best supports that claim?

- A.** Survey mentored employees on whether they plan to stay.
- B.** Compare turnover of employees who volunteered for mentoring with those who did not.
- C.** Randomly assign eligible new hires to mentoring or no mentoring and compare first-year turnover.
- D.** Correlate mentoring hours with tenure across all employees.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A hospital system started the year with 1,150 nurses and ended with 1,250; average headcount was 1,200. During the year 180 nurses left, 30 of them through retirement. HR also hired 280 nurses, many through a new referral bonus. What was the annual turnover rate?

- A.** 14.4%
- B.** 15.0%
- C.** 23.3%
- D.** 12.5%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A call center averaged 400 employees last year and reported 22.5% annual turnover. How many employees separated?

- A.** 90
- B.** It cannot be found without starting and ending headcount.
- C.** About 18
- D.** 310

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A 900-employee credit union with a new CHRO and a \$1.2 million budget wants to replace its HR spreadsheets with an HRIS. The CHRO favors a vendor whose demo impressed the executive team. What should come first?

- A. Train all employees on self-service features.
- B. A needs analysis that maps current HR processes and documents requirements with stakeholders.
- C. Migrate all employee data into a new database now to save time later.
- D. Sign with the vendor whose demo impressed the executives.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A manufacturer's HRIS stores salaries, medical leave notes, and performance ratings. The system was configured by a respected consulting firm last spring. A new team lead in the plant asks for access so she can check her direct reports' vacation balances. What access should she get?

- A. Read-only access to the whole HRIS.
- B. Full manager access to her team's records, including medical leave notes.
- C. A role-based view of her direct reports' leave balances only.
- D. No access at all; HR must answer every such question.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

An analyst at a 3,000-person retailer is asked to report average time-to-fill by department for the quarterly board deck, due Friday. She notices 140 requisitions whose close date is earlier than their open date. The CEO likes charts in the company colors. What should she do first?

- A. Report the median instead, which fixes bad data.
- B. Investigate the 140 records, correct or exclude them, and note the fix before calculating.
- C. Delete the records quietly so the deck is ready by Friday.
- D. Calculate with all records; errors average out in a large dataset.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An HR analyst found that employees with no promotion within three years quit at twice the rate of others, costing about \$2.4 million a year. She built the model in Python using 14 variables. She has ten minutes with the executive team. How should she open?

- A. Walk through the Python model and its 14 variables so they trust the method.
- B. Say the model proves promotions will stop turnover.
- C. Show a full table of every coefficient.
- D. State the \$2.4 million cost and her recommended action, then show the key supporting evidence.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A company used a new screening tool, purchased from a vendor that advertises it as bias-free, on 500 applicants. Of 200 Group A applicants, 120 passed; of 300 Group B applicants, 105 passed. Under the four-fifths rule, is there evidence of adverse impact?

- A. Yes: $35\% / 60\% \approx 0.58$, below 0.80.
- B. No: the vendor certifies the tool as bias-free.
- C. No: 105 passes is close to 120 passes.
- D. No: the ratio is $60 / 35 \approx 1.71$, above 0.80.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Group A has the highest selection rate at 50%. What is the lowest selection rate Group B can have without indicating adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

- A. 80%
- B. 62.5%
- C. 40%
- D. 50%; any lower rate shows adverse impact.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

An HR analytics team at a 4,000-employee logistics firm ~~that recently moved to a cloud HRIS~~ built a model using tenure, commute distance, and engagement scores to estimate which warehouse employees are likely to quit in the next six months. ~~The project was sponsored by the COO.~~ Which type of analytics is this?

Target word: type of analytics **Decides:** It estimates who is likely to quit in the future.

A	Adjacent category	Descriptive reports what already happened, such as last year's quit count.
B	Confusion set	Prescriptive recommends an action; this model only flags risk.
C	Confusion set	Diagnostic explains why past turnover happened, not who will leave next.
D	Correct	Estimating the likelihood of a future event is predictive.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which question calls for prescriptive analytics?

Target word: reverse: from level to question **Decides:** Prescriptive answers "what should we do?"

A	Correct	It asks for a recommended action, which is prescriptive.
B	Dropped element	Predicts risk but stops short of recommending an action.
C	Adjacent category	A count of what happened is descriptive.
D	Confusion set	A why question is diagnostic.

3. Answer D Concept 2

Survey data at a regional bank ~~with 22 branches~~ show that branches with more training hours also have higher customer satisfaction scores ($r = 0.62$). ~~The survey vendor has won industry awards.~~ A VP proposes doubling training hours at every branch to raise satisfaction. What is the best response?

Target word: what the correlation supports **Decides:** A correlation alone cannot show that training causes satisfaction.

A	Camouflage	The vendor's reputation does not turn correlation into causation.
B	Absolute language	No correlation, however strong, proves cause.
C	Inverted operation	Flips the causal direction; the data support neither direction on their own.
D	Correct	A controlled comparison is needed before making a causal claim and scaling spending.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

An analyst wants to show that a new mentoring program causes lower first-year turnover. Which design best supports that claim?

Target word: design that supports a causal claim **Decides:** Random assignment removes self-selection and confounders.

A	Confusion set	Stated intent is not actual turnover, and there is no comparison group.
B	Dropped element	Drops random assignment; volunteers may already be more committed.
C	Correct	Random assignment makes the groups comparable, so a difference can be credited to the program.
D	Adjacent category	Still a correlation; long-tenured staff may simply have had more time to be mentored.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A hospital system started the year with 1,150 nurses and ended with 1,250; average headcount was 1,200. During the year 180 nurses left, 30 of them through retirement. HR also hired 280 nurses, ~~many through a new referral bonus~~. What was the annual turnover rate?

Target word: annual turnover rate **Decides:** Separations 180 / average headcount 1,200.

A	Wrong stem number	180 / 1,250 uses ending headcount instead of average.
B	Correct	180 / 1,200 = 15.0%; total turnover counts all separations, retirements included.
C	Confusion set	280 / 1,200 uses hires instead of separations.
D	Dropped element	150 / 1,200 leaves out the 30 retirements.

6. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A call center averaged 400 employees last year and reported 22.5% annual turnover. How many employees separated?

Target word: solve for separations **Decides:** Separations = rate × average headcount.

A	Correct	$0.225 \times 400 = 90$.
B	Absolute language	Average headcount is already given; that is all the formula needs.
C	Inverted operation	Divides 400 by 22.5 instead of multiplying by 0.225.
D	Confusion set	That is the number who stayed ($400 - 90$), not who left.

7. Answer B Concept 4

A 900-employee credit union ~~with a new CHRO and a \$1.2 million budget~~ wants to replace its HR spreadsheets with an HRIS. The CHRO favors a vendor ~~whose demo impressed the executive team~~. What should come first?

Target word: first step in implementation **Decides:** Requirements must be defined before any vendor can be judged.

A	Adjacent category	Training is a late-stage rollout step.
B	Correct	Requirements are the yardstick for selecting and configuring any system.
C	Inverted operation	Migration comes after selection and configuration, not before.
D	Camouflage	A good demo is not evidence the system fits this organization's needs.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A manufacturer's HRIS stores salaries, medical leave notes, and performance ratings. ~~The system was configured by a respected consulting firm last spring.~~ A new team lead in the plant asks for access so she can check her direct reports' vacation balances. What access should she get?

Target word: appropriate access level **Decides:** Her task needs only her reports' leave balances.

A	Adjacent category	Read-only still exposes salaries and medical data she has no need to see.
B	Dropped element	Drops the minimum-necessary limit; medical notes are not needed for balances.
C	Correct	Least privilege: access matches the task and nothing more.
D	Absolute language	Least privilege limits access, it does not forbid needed access.

9. Answer B Concept 6

An analyst at a 3,000-person retailer is asked to report average time-to-fill by department for the quarterly board deck, due Friday. She notices 140 requisitions whose close date is earlier than their open date. The CEO likes charts in the company colors. What should she do first?

Target word: first step with invalid records **Decides:** Negative durations are invalid data that will distort the average.

A	Adjacent category	A median is less sensitive to outliers but does not make invalid records valid.
B	Correct	Validate and document before analysis so the metric is trustworthy.
C	Camouflage	The deadline does not justify undocumented changes.
D	Dropped element	Skips validation; negative values pull the average down, they do not cancel.

10. Answer D Concept 7

An HR analyst found that employees with no promotion within three years quit at twice the rate of others, costing about \$2.4 million a year. She built the model in Python using 14 variables. She has ten minutes with the executive team. How should she open?

Target word: how to open an executive briefing **Decides:** Executives with ten minutes need impact and a decision first.

A	Camouflage	Method detail belongs in backup; it uses up the limited time.
B	Absolute language	Overclaims; the finding is an association with a cost estimate.
C	Adjacent category	Useful for analysts, not a way to open with leaders.
D	Correct	Lead with business impact and the ask; details support it.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A company used a new screening tool, purchased from a vendor that advertises it as bias free, on 500 applicants. Of 200 Group A applicants, 120 passed; of 300 Group B applicants, 105 passed. Under the four-fifths rule, is there evidence of adverse impact?

Target word: adverse impact yes/no **Decides:** Rates: A 60%, B 35%; $35 / 60 \approx 0.58$.

A	Correct	Group B's rate is under four-fifths of Group A's.
B	Camouflage	Marketing claims do not replace the outcome test.
C	Dropped element	Compares counts and drops the different group sizes.
D	Inverted operation	Divides the higher rate by the lower; the rule divides the lower by the highest.

12. Answer C Concept 8 · transfer

Group A has the highest selection rate at 50%. What is the lowest selection rate Group B can have without indicating adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

Target word: solve for the threshold rate **Decides:** $0.80 \times 50\% = 40\%$.

A	Wrong stem number	The ratio threshold, not a selection rate.
B	Inverted operation	Divides 50% by 0.8 instead of multiplying.
C	Correct	Four-fifths of 50% is 40%.
D	Absolute language	The rule allows up to a one-fifth relative shortfall.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Levels of analytics	Descriptive says what happened, diagnostic says why, predictive says what is likely, prescriptive says what to do.	Calling any model with numbers 'prescriptive' or any report 'predictive'.	The verb in the question: happened, why, likely, or should.
2	Correlation is not causation	A relationship in the data does not show that one factor causes the other; causal claims need a controlled comparison.	Scaling a program because two measures move together.	An r value followed by a proposal to change one variable.
3	Turnover rate	Turnover rate = separations during the period / average headcount for the period.	Dividing by ending headcount or counting hires.	Starting, ending, and average headcount plus separations in one stem.
4	HRIS implementation sequence	Start with a needs analysis of processes and requirements before vendor selection, then configure, migrate, test, train.	Picking the vendor with the best demo first.	"What should come first?" in a system project.
5	Least privilege and HR data privacy	Give each role access only to the data it needs for its task; sensitive fields stay restricted.	Granting broad access because the person is a manager.	A user asks for access to do one narrow task.
6	Data quality before analysis	Validate and fix or exclude invalid records, and document it, before computing metrics.	Assuming large datasets average out bad records.	Impossible values (end before start, negative durations) in the data.
7	Communicating insights to leaders	Lead with the business impact and recommendation, then show only the evidence needed.	Opening with methodology and model details.	Limited time with executives.
8	Adverse impact (four-fifths rule)	If a group's selection rate is less than 80% of the highest group's rate, that signals adverse impact.	Comparing raw counts instead of rates.	Applicants and hires by group for a screening tool.

Course scope (public description): Data and technology are reshaping HR into a function that provides both insight and support. This course introduces you to human resource information systems and people analytics, demonstrating how HR professionals utilize data to make informed decisions. You will learn how to implement systems, interpret data, and communicate insights that influence leaders and shape strategy.